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Project Quartz — Confirmatory IP Due-Diligence and Freedom-to-Operate Note

To: Dr Eleanor Aldridge, CEO; the Board of Aldridge Biomaterials Limited

From: James Osei / Elena Marchetti, Whitfield Carter LLP (with Hartington IP)

Date: 4 November 2025

1. Purpose and scope

This note summarises the confirmatory intellectual-property due diligence carried out on the AB-COAT™ patent family in connection with the proposed exclusive licence to Brandt Packaging Solutions GmbH (Project Quartz), and our freedom-to-operate (FTO) assessment for the compostable flexible-packaging field in the proposed Territory. It is provided for the Company's internal purposes and is subject to legal professional privilege.

2. Ownership and status of the Licensed Patents

We reviewed the patent register entries, assignment chain and renewal records (with Hartington IP) for the five members of the patent family. Our findings:

- Ownership: Aldridge Biomaterials Limited is recorded as sole proprietor of each granted patent and applicant for each pending application. The chain of title from the named inventors (Dr E. Aldridge and Dr M. Tindall) is complete, supported by executed assignments dated 11 January 2021.
- Granted rights: GB2598412B, EP3984210B1 (validated in DE, FR, IT, ES and NL) and GB2611507A are granted and in force; renewal fees are paid to date.
- Pending rights: EP4123901A1 is under examination (first examination report responded to 12 June 2025); WO2023/118802 has entered national phase in the US, JP and CA.
- Encumbrances: No security interests, liens or co-ownership were identified. There is one historic evaluation licence to Verdant Packaging Trials Ltd (non-exclusive, expiring 31 March 2026), addressed in the side letter.

3. Validity considerations

No invalidity or opposition proceedings are pending against any granted family member. A third-party observation was filed against EP4123901A1 citing US2019/0241758; Hartington IP considers the cited art distinguishable on the basis of the claimed aqueous-deposition step and assesses a grant likelihood of approximately 70%. We recommend the Licence treat ungranted applications as carrying no validity warranty (reflected in clause 9.2).

4. Freedom to operate

Our FTO search (conducted by Hartington IP, reviewed by us) identified two third-party patent families of potential relevance in the Territory: (a) a Kuraray-held family on PVOH-based barrier coatings, which we consider non-infringing because AB-COAT™ uses a non-PVOH bio-derived polymer matrix; and (b) an expired BASF family (lapsed 2019) that poses no risk. On the basis of the searches conducted, we consider the risk that manufacture and sale of Licensed Products in the Field infringes subsisting third-party rights in the Territory to be low, although no FTO assessment can be conclusive.

5. Recommendations

1. Proceed with the Licence on the basis that ownership is clean and the FTO risk is low.
2. Carve the Verdant Packaging Trials evaluation licence out of exclusivity until 31 March 2026 (done in the side letter).
3. Limit warranties on pending applications and exclude any warranty that patents will proceed to grant (clause 9.2).
4. Maintain the indemnity at clause 12 within the negotiated liability cap of £3,000,000.

Please contact us with any questions on this note.